

# Wei(Rocio) Zhong

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| CONTACT INFORMATION   | Department of Political Science<br>Stony Brook University                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | wei.zhong.1@stonybrook.edu<br><a href="https://rociozhong.github.io">https://rociozhong.github.io</a> |
| ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS | <b>Stony Brook University</b> , Stony Brook, NY<br>Department of Political Science<br><br>Assistant Professor, Sep 2025 – Present<br><br><b>New York University</b> , New York, NY<br>Center for Social Media and Politics<br><br>Postdoctoral Research Scientist, Sep 2023 – Aug 2025<br><br><b>George Washington University</b> , Washington, DC<br>Institute for Data, Democracy & Politics, School of Engineering and Applied Science<br><br>Research Scientist, Feb 2021 – Aug 2023                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                       |
| EDUCATION             | <b>University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign</b> , Urbana, IL<br><br>Ph.D., Political Science, Aug 2021<br>Dissertation: “Candidates, the Economy and Voting Behavior”<br><br>M.S., Statistics, May 2018<br><br><b>New York University</b> , New York, NY<br><br>M.A., Politics, May 2014<br><br><b>University of International Business and Economics</b> , Beijing, China<br><br>B.A., Spanish, Jun 2009                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                       |
| RESEARCH INTEREST     | Comparative Politics, Political Methodology<br>Online Hate and Extremism, Polarization, Social Media, Computational Methods                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                       |
| PUBLICATIONS          | <b>Zhong, W.</b> , & Broniatowski, D.A. (2023). Economic risk framing increases intention to vaccinate among Republican COVID-19 vaccine refusers. <i>Social Science &amp; Medicine</i> , 317, 115594.<br><br>Bailard, C., Tromble, R., <b>Zhong, W.</b> , Bianchi, F., Hosseini, P., & Broniatowski, D.A. (2024). “Keep Your Heads Held High Boys!”: Examining the Relationship between the Proud Boys’ Online Discourse and Offline Activities. <i>American Political Science Review</i> , 1–18.<br><br><b>Zhong, W.</b> , Bailard, C., Broniatowski, D., & Tromble, R. (2024). Proud Boys on Telegram. <i>Journal of Quantitative Description: Digital Media</i> , 4, 1–47.<br><br><b>Zhong, W.</b> , & Zhang, M. (2025). Subdued but Unbroken: The Cohesion of Far-Right Extremist Followers after Deplatforming. <i>Perspectives on Politics</i> , 1-26.<br><br>Lukito, J., Macdonald, M., Chen, B., Brown, M.A., Prochaska, S., Yang, Y., Greenfield, J., Suk, J., <b>Zhong, W.</b> , Dahlke, R., & Borah, P. (2025). Candidates Be Posting: Multi-Platform Strategies and Partisan Preferences in the 2022 US Midterm Elections. <i>Social Media+ Society</i> , 11(2).<br><br><b>Zhong, W.</b> , Chen, B., Liang, F. & Zhang, M. (2025). Picturing Protest: A Deep Dive into the Visual Representation of Protests in Authoritarian Countries’ Media on Twitter. <i>Digital Journalism</i> , 1-22<br><br>Broniatowski, D., <b>Zhong, W.</b> , W., Simons, J.R., Jamison, A.M., Dredze, M., & Abrams, L.C. (2025). Explaining Twitter’s inability to effectively moderate content during the COVID-19 pandemic. <i>Scientific Reports</i> , 15(1), 36096. |                                                                                                       |

Lukito, J., Pruden, M. L., Suk, J., Yang, Y., & **Zhong, W.** (2026). Political Communication Special Issue Introduction: Multi-Platform Research. *Political Communication*, 43(2), 175–191.

Lukito, J., Zhang, Y., Chen, B., Prochaska, S., Pruden, M.L., Yang, Y., **Zhong, W.**, Brown, M., Dahlke, R., Greenfield, J., Suk, J., & Borah, P. (Forthcoming). Cross-Platformization: How U.S. Right-Leaning Media Curate Their Posts on Twitter and Truth Social. *New Media & Society*.

UNDER REVIEW Suk, J.\*, **Zhong, W.\***, Zhang, Y., Pruden M., Yang, Y., Mao, C., & DiFranzo D. Unveiling Engagement and Platform Algorithmic Biases in Social Media Data Collection and Analysis: An Experimental Study. (R&R) [\*co-first author]

**Zhong, W.** From Policy to Personality: How Americans Evaluate Presidential Candidates, 1984–2020. (R&R)

Sanderson, Z.\*, **Zhong, W.\***, & Tucker, J.A. It Works When It Works: Measuring the Direct and Indirect Effects of AI Labels on Political Images. (R&R) [\*co-first author]

**Zhong, W.**, Tan, H., Wang, B., & Zhang, K. Self-reinforcing media antagonism sustains U.S.-China rivalry

**Zhong, W.**, Zhang, Y., & Xu, Y. Territorial Contraction: Far-Right Mobilization and Everyday Public Life in American Neighborhoods

SELECTED WORKS IN PROGRESS Bisbee J, & **Zhong, W.** WLM Telegram: Images and Text  
**Zhong, W.**, Much, M., Nagler, J., & Tucker, J.A. Tweets and Beliefs: Online Political Environments and Immigration Attitudes

**Zhong, W.**, & Nagler, J. Opinion Change and Voter Learning across Political Issues in U.S. Elections.

**Zhong, W.**, Xu, X., & Chen, H. The Rise and Contestation of Identity in Global Media

Barrie, C., Zhang, M., **Zhong, W.**, Nagler, J., & Tucker, J.A. Social Media and Cross-Cutting Conversations

SELECTED PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE **US 2020 Presidential Election Researcher** Dec 2021 - Sep 2023  
META (formerly Facebook)  
Menlo Park, CA

**Data Science Research Intern** May 2019 - Aug 2019  
DiDi AI LABS  
Beijing, China

TEACHING EXPERIENCE **Instructor**  
POL 201 Introduction to Statistical Methods in Political Science, SBU Spring 2026  
POL 604 Quantitative Analysis III (Graduate), SBU Fall 2025  
PS 385 Politics of the European Union (Online), UIUC Spring 2020  
PS 241 Comparative Politics in Developing Nations (Online), UIUC Fall 2019, Spring 2018

**Teaching Assistant**  
Quantitative Analysis I, II, III (Graduate), UIUC 2018–2019  
Introduction to Political Research, UIUC Spring 2017  
Introduction to International Relations, UIUC Spring 2016

LANGUAGES English(fluent), Chinese(native), Spanish(proficient)

SOFTWARE Python, R, SQL, LATEX, Git, ArcGIS

## SERVICES

### **Manuscript Referee**

American Political Science Review, Political Behavior, Political Communication, Journal of Experimental Political Science, PNAS Nexus, Nature Communications

### **Guest Editor**

Special Issue on Multi-Platform Research for *Political Communication*